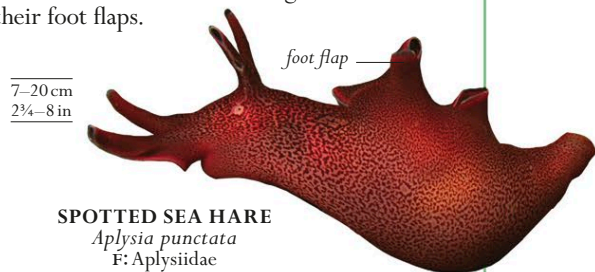


## SEA HARES

Sensory water-tasting head stalks, a common feature of sea slugs, are so big in the large sea hares that they resemble ears. The Anaspidea have a small internal shell and, like sea angels, can swim with their foot flaps.

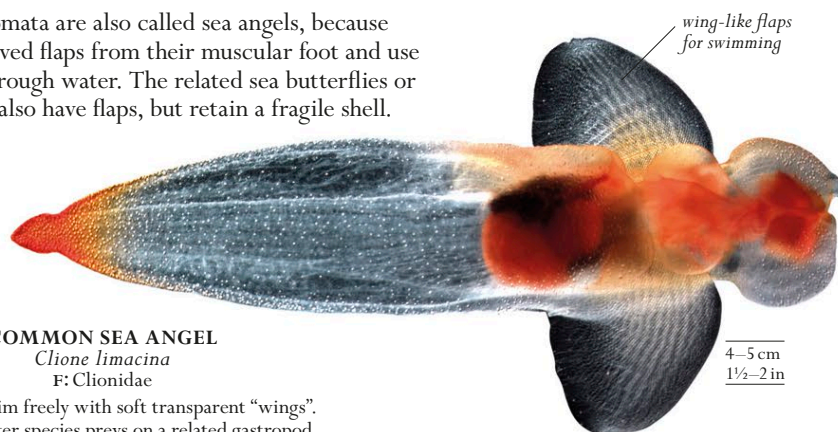


**SPOTTED SEA HARE**  
*Aplysia punctata*  
F: Aplysiidae

Like other seaweed-eating sea hares, this European species gathers in large breeding groups. As a defence, it releases ink when disturbed by predators.

## SWIMMING SEA SLUGS

The Gymnosomata are also called sea angels, because they have evolved flaps from their muscular foot and use them to fly through water. The related sea butterflies or Thecosomata also have flaps, but retain a fragile shell.

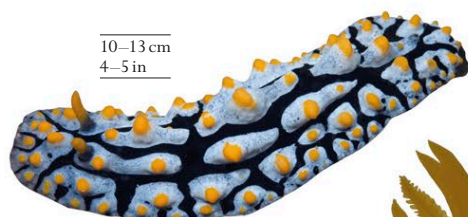


**COMMON SEA ANGEL**  
*Clione limacina*  
F: Clionidae

Sea angels swim freely with soft transparent “wings”. This cold-water species preys on a related gastropod called the Arctic sea butterfly (*Limacina helicina*).

## TRUE SEA SLUGS

The Nudibranchia are the largest group of sea slugs. Nudibranch means “naked gills” and refers to the fact that these animals’ gills are exposed on their back, rather than enclosed in a mantle cavity. Many species have vibrant colour patterns to advertise their toxicity.



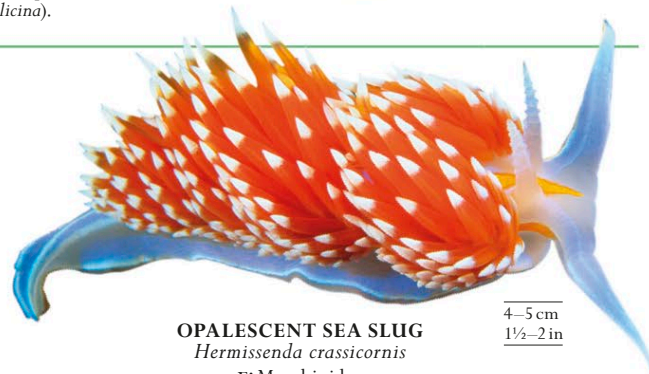
**VARICOSE SEA SLUG**  
*Phyllidia varicosa*  
F: Phyllidiidae

This Indo-Pacific sea slug is a common inhabitant of rocks, rubble, and sand in coastal waters, where it preys on sponges.



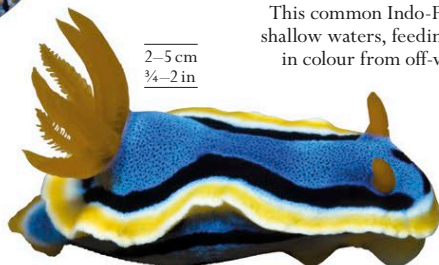
**BLACK-MARGINED SEA SLUG**  
*Doriprismatica atromarginata*  
F: Chromodorididae

This common Indo-Pacific sea slug lives in shallow waters, feeding on sponges. It varies in colour from off-white to pale yellow.



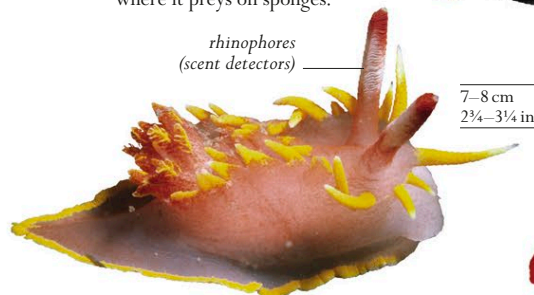
**OPALESCENT SEA SLUG**  
*Hermisenda crassicornis*  
F: Myrrhinidae

This intertidal northern Pacific species belongs to a group of sea slugs with body outgrowths that store the still potent stinging organs of their jellyfish prey.



**ANNA'S SEA SLUG**  
*Chromodoris annae*  
F: Chromodorididae

Like other *Chromodoris* sea slugs, this variable species from the western Pacific Ocean specializes in feeding on sponges.



**ELEGANT SEA SLUG**  
*Okenia elegans*  
F: Goniadorididae

Typical of its family, this sea slug feeds on sea squirts. It occurs in waters around Europe, including the Mediterranean.



**VARIABLE NEON SEA SLUG**  
*Nembrotha kubaryana*  
F: Polyceridae

This Indo-Pacific sea slug preys on sea squirts and incorporates their defensive chemicals into its mucus. Many of its relatives prey on bryozoans.



**SPANISH DANCER**  
*Hexabranchus sanguineus*  
F: Hexabranchidae

A giant Indo-Pacific sea slug, this species gets its name from its free-swimming movements; its red mantle is said to resemble the ruffled skirt of a flamenco dancer.